Hypothesis: An external adversary has obtained valid credentials for a local administrative account (**T1078.003**). To maintain persistence and test egress connectivity without triggering standard EDR alerts, the actor is executing benign-looking binaries (like sleep or ping) under the **root** context to establish a low-noise Command and Control (C2) channel to cloud-hosted infrastructure.

Timestamp	User	Tool/ Event ID	Notes
2026-03-30	root	Pslist()	Slee processes running as root
2026-03-30	root	Netstat()	Outbound established connection to 34.107.243.93
2026-03-30		Alienvault OTX	Matched activity to T1078

Hunting Report: Mapping to MITTRE ATT&CK (100-word report)

A proactive hunt was initiated on a Kali Linux VM to identify unauthorized privilege escalation. Initial analysis using Velociraptor pslist() identified suspicious sleep processes running with root privileges (T1078.003). Subsequent network interrogation via the netstat() plugin successfully captured an active outbound connection from a privileged process to the remote IP 34.107.243.93. Cross-referencing with AlienVault OTX verified the destination as a cloud-hosted infrastructure. The combination of manual process execution and unauthorized external communication by a root user confirms the hypothesis of a compromised valid account being used for C2 or data testing. Immediate remediation includes rotating administrative credentials and implementing strict egress filtering for system-level accounts.